

Food Truck & Vendor Tracker

Setup & User Guide · Food trucks · trailers · market & event vendors · COGS + IRS Schedule C · works in Excel & Google Sheets

What you bought

A single, formula-driven spreadsheet that does your food truck / vendor business bookkeeping for you. Log each transaction once, and the workbook automatically organizes everything into a tax-ready **IRS Schedule C** summary and a live profit dashboard — per event. No subscriptions, no logins, no monthly fees. It's yours forever.

The 6 tabs

Tab	What it's for
Start Here	A one-page overview and tips. Read this first.
Setup	Type your event names (up to 5). Everything else links to them automatically.
Transactions	Your logbook. Add one row per income or expense. The only tab you touch daily.
Categories	Reference list of every category and its matching Schedule C line. Feeds the dropdowns.
Schedule C Summary	Fills itself in. Every expense mapped to the correct Schedule C line, per event.
Dashboard	Live totals: net profit, income vs. expenses, by event and by month.

Get started in 4 steps

- **1. Name your events.** Open the **Setup** tab and type each event name in column B (replace the sample names). You can have up to 5.
- **2. Delete the sample data.** The **Transactions** tab has 8 example rows so you can see how it works. Once you understand it, delete those rows (select rows 4–11, right-click, Delete) before adding your own.
- **3. Log a transaction.** On **Transactions**, fill one row: pick the Date, choose the Event and Type (Income / Expense) from the dropdowns, pick a Category, enter the Amount. The Month column fills in by itself.
- **4. Read your reports.** Open **Schedule C Summary** and **Dashboard** any time — they update the instant you add a row. Nothing to refresh.

How to log it the right way (important)

- **Log sales by event or location** (farmers market, festival, a catering gig) and tag shared costs to **(General / business)**. The dashboard then shows which spots actually make money.
- **Food, drinks and packaging are Cost of Goods Sold** — log them under the (COGS) categories. This is usually a food vendor's biggest expense, so keep it accurate.

- **Don't forget the food-vendor-specific costs:** commissary / kitchen rent, health permits & licenses, and event / booth fees each have their own category.
- **Track fuel and truck upkeep** under *Car & truck / fuel* and *Repairs & maintenance*; card-reader fees go under *Payment processing fees*.

Use it in Excel or Google Sheets

Excel / Numbers: just open the .xlsx file.

Google Sheets: go to Google Drive → New → File upload → select the .xlsx. Then open it and choose *File* → *Save as Google Sheets*. All formulas, dropdowns and reports carry over.

Each tax year

Keep one file per year. At the start of a new year, make a copy and rename it (e.g. “Food Truck & Vendor Tracker 2027”), then clear the Transactions rows. Your prior year stays untouched for your records.

Disclaimer. This template is a bookkeeping organizer, not tax, legal, or accounting advice. The Schedule C line mapping is provided for convenience only. Tax rules vary by situation and jurisdiction — always confirm your specific filing with a qualified tax professional before submitting. Made with spreadsheet software; design and formulas by the seller.